convince the world to undermine the Rabbani government. Instead, images of rough justice including stoning women to death in football stadiums came to symbolise the Taliban. Massoud, on the other hand, emerged as a visionary commander fighting this menace. Passed unanimously within the UNSC, India embraced resolution 1076, refused to recognise the Taliban, and refused to reopen its embassy in Kabul like many other countries. It allowed the Rabbani government to retain an embassy in New Delhi with Massoud Khalili as ambassador. India's political sympathies were out in the open. As per the advocacy coalition framework, the partisans found allies in the form of world opinion on the Taliban, and a solid diplomatic tool in the form of resolution 1076 to manipulate New Delhi's policy towards not engaging with the Taliban. This was anomalous in light of the Rao doctrine and India's bitter experience of emerging on the losing side in 1992. Two questions emerge. One, how inextricably linked was India's Afghanistan policy to the UN deliberations to broker peace? And two, how did regional and global strategic alignments shape India's Afghanistan policy? While the following paragraphs examine India's role at the UN, sections after this delve into Iran, Russia, and the CAR's role in strengthening the partisans.

A traditional believer in the UN and the norms espoused by the international institution, India wanted it to play an active role in resolving the Afghan conflict.[74] In addition to stabilising the situation, from an Indian perspective, UN intervention would undercut Pakistan's influence on domestic Afghan affairs. Expecting Pakistan and its proxies to limit their ambitions in the wake of a UN brokered truce, the idea was to bring an international conflict monitoring agency that could help endorse an 'Afghan solution'.[75] New Delhi had 'welcomed the UN Secretary General's Five-Point Peace Proposals in May 1991' and wanted full settlement of the Afghan crisis, 'based on her conviction that any such settlement should recognise the legitimate interests of all concerned'.[76] Drafted by Benon Sevan, the proposal entailed a triangular dialogue between Najibullah, the Pakistan government and the Pakistan-based Mujahideen. Its key elements entailed an intra-Afghan dialogue to build 'a credible and impartial transition mechanism', that would have a broad-based mandate from the people of Afghanistan and allow them an opportunity to participate in free and fair